MATTERYA

Content Moderator Handbook

Beginner training guide · Chapters · Definitions · Examples
Claim-next follows Meta + TikTok safety patterns
Version 2026-10-31

You answer questions. Policy applies the result.
No prior moderation experience required.

Who this is for: new moderators with no prior experience

Where you work: https://api.matterya.com/reports

Accounts queue: https://api.matterya.com/reports/accounts

This handbook: https://api.matterya.com/management/policy

PDF: download from Management → Policy handbook (or `/moderation/Matterya-Moderator-Handbook.pdf`)

You do **not** decide “Remove” or “Keep” yourself. You answer simple questions. Matterya policy applies the result.

Chapter 0 — Your first day

What is your job?

People report posts (or our systems flag them). You open one ticket at a time, look at the content, and answer the questions on the right. That is Claim-next.

How a ticket works (step by step)

- Open **Content queue** and log in with the shared password.

- You see one post (or comment): author, text, media, sometimes reporters.

- On the right, answer the questions with number keys (`1`, `2`, …) or by clicking.

- `Backspace` goes back a step. `Enter` confirms the final answer.

- `P` **passes** the ticket to another moderator if you are stuck or conflicted.

- The screen says **“Decision recorded”** and gives you the next ticket. You will not see whether content was removed — that is intentional.

What happens after you answer

Policy result (hidden from you)	What it means for users
Remove	Content is taken down. Author is notified. A strike may be added.
Mark	Content stays, but is treated as sensitive / mature.
Dismiss	No violation (or false alarm). Flags cleared.

Severe removals open an **Account review** ticket right away. **Mild** removals add a strike; at **3** open strikes the account goes to Account review.

Golden rules (memorize these)

- **Anyone under 18 + sexual content** → always choose **CSAM** (Chapter 1). Never “art,” never Mature.

- **Threat with a place, time, target, or method** → choose the path that says **escalate**.

- If you are unsure on a normal ticket → press P (Pass). Do not guess.

- If it is high-stakes and still unclear after reading → **Escalate** → **Specialist second look**.

- Be kind to survivors describing their own harm. Prefer recovery / help paths, not punishment of the victim's post.

Rules we follow

Claim-next follows **Meta** and **TikTok** style safety rules (they have the most experience). YouTube-style "keep for documentary" rules are for a **different longform-video queue**, not this one.

Chapter 0b — Words you'll hear (short glossary)

Word	Plain meaning
CSAM	Child Sexual Abuse Material — any sexual content involving someone under 18
NCII	Non-Consensual Intimate Imagery — private nude/sex images shared without permission
Doxxing	Publishing someone's private info (address, phone, ID) to harm or expose them
Escalate	Special safety path: remove + send the account for urgent review
Strike	A mark against an account after a remove
Masquerade	Matterya's anonymous / adult-friendly area (Spaces can be labeled adult)
Claim-next	One-ticket-at-a-time review screen
Pass (P)	Give this ticket to another moderator

Chapter 1 — CSAM

Definition

CSAM means any sexual content involving a person under 18 — photos, video, drawings, AI, or text — including grooming (trying to get a minor into sexual chat or meetings).

Why it is #1

Zero tolerance. Same idea as Meta and TikTok. Always treated as **severe**. Confirmed or suspected cases **escalate**.

How to click

Step 2 → **1 CSAM**, then pick the closest option. If a minor is involved sexually, you are in the right chapter.

Examples

Example	What you choose
Training: “post asks a 15-year-old for nudes”	CSAM → Grooming → **escalate**
Training: “AI image of a child in a sexual pose”	CSAM → Confirmed CSAM → **escalate**
Training: “adult jokes about teens sexually”	CSAM → Sexualization → **escalate**
Real-style adult Masquerade caption (“Getting all the cum out”) with **no minor**	**Not CSAM** → Mature or Adult solicitation (later chapters)

Do not

- Do not pick Mature for anything involving a minor.
- Do not dismiss as “cartoon” or “fiction” if the character is a child.

Chapter 2 — Self-harm / suicide

Definition

Content about hurting yourself or ending your life — including instructions, graphic images, crisis posts, or recovery stories.

How to click

Step 2 → **2 Self-harm / suicide**. First question: is there an **active crisis with a concrete plan**? If yes → **escalate**.

Examples

Example	What you choose
“Here’s exactly how to cut deeper — try this tonight”	Promotion / instruction → remove (severe)
“I have pills ready at midnight, this is it”	Active crisis with plan → **escalate**
“I’ve been struggling; does anyone have a hotline?”	Ideation seeking help → mark (keep for help)
“One year clean — sharing my recovery story” (no graphic method)	Recovery → dismiss
“Pro-ana tips to stay under 80 lbs”	Disordered eating promo → remove

Chapter 3 — Terrorism

Definition

Content that supports terrorist groups, helps plan attacks, threatens attacks, or glorifies terrorist violence. News that clearly condemns an attack is different.

How to click

Step 2 → **3 Terrorism**.

Examples

Example	What you choose
“Join [terror group], here’s how to donate / train”	Recruitment / ops → remove (severe)
“That bombing was glorious, more please”	Praise / propaganda → remove (severe)
“I’ll bomb [named building] at 3pm Friday”	Threat with **place + time** → **escalate**
“Someone should bomb something someday” (no place/time/target)	Vague threat → remove (severe), not escalate
News clip: “Attack condemned; victims remembered”	News / condemnation → mark
History class post about a past event, no praise	Historical / educational → dismiss

Remember: place, time, target, or method → **escalate** (same idea Meta / TikTok use for actionable threats).

Chapter 4 — Violence / graphic harm

Definition

Real gore, animal cruelty, calls to commit violent crime, or graphic clips. Movie/game violence that is clearly fiction is usually OK. News graphic can stay with a sensitive mark.

How to click

Step 2 → **4 Violence / graphic harm**.

Examples

Example	What you choose
Shock clip of real mutilation posted for likes	Gore → remove (severe)
Video of someone hurting an animal for fun	Animal cruelty → remove (severe)
“Go beat up the people at that protest tonight”	Incitement → remove (severe)
Clear gameplay / movie fight scene	Fictional → dismiss
From our queue: NSFW news report of an attacked man with facial injuries, framed as news from Peru	News / documentary graphic → **mark**

Chapter 5 — Servitude / domestic helpers

Definition

Forced labor, trafficking of domestic workers (“helpers” / maids), debt bondage, or deceptive job ads that trap people. A normal “hiring a nanny” ad is fine.

How to click

Step 2 → **5 Servitude / domestic helpers**.

Examples

Example	What you choose
“We keep her passport; she works off the debt”	Debt bondage → remove (severe)
Organized ring moving domestic workers under false contracts	Trafficking confirmed → **escalate**
“$50/month live-in maid, no days off, we take papers”	Forced servitude → remove (severe)
“Hiring live-in helper, legal contract, fair wage” (no coercion)	Legitimate job → dismiss
Minor forced to work as a helper	→ CSAM escalate

Chapter 6 — Harassment / bullying

Definition

Targeting a real person to insult, humiliate, threaten, stalk, or sexually pressure them.

How to click

Step 2 → **6 Harassment / bullying**.

Examples

Example	What you choose
“@username you’re a worthless idiot, kms” aimed at one person	Targeted cursing / bullying → remove
“I’ll be at your apartment at 9 with a bat”	Credible threat with place/time → **escalate**
“I’m gonna kill this exam lol”	Hyperbole → mark / not a real threat
“Hope you get cancer and die”	Death wish → remove (severe)
Repeated unwanted DMs after being told to stop	Stalking → remove (severe); escalate if swatting / showing up
Unwanted sexual comments to a person	Unsolicited sexual → remove
Sextortion of an adult with “pay or I post your nudes”	Sexual blackmail → remove (severe); if minor → CSAM

Chapter 7 — Hate speech

Definition

Attacking people because of who they are: race, ethnicity, religion, gender, sexual orientation, disability, and similar protected traits. Insulting a politician's *ideas* is usually not hate.

How to click

Step 2 → **7 Hate speech**.

Examples

Example	What you choose
Calling a racial group "animals" or "subhuman"	Dehumanizing → remove (severe)
Slurs aimed at a protected group	Slurs → remove (severe)
"Those people shouldn't be allowed here / should be segregated"	Exclusion → remove (severe)
Lazy demeaning stereotype of a protected group	Stereotype → remove
Praise of a hate group or atrocity	Praise → remove (severe)
Friend group reclaiming a slur about themselves, no attack on others	Reclaimed → dismiss
From our queue: "Downtown Miami…" tourism clip wrongly tagged hate	Likely **false positive** → Step 1 "No — allow" or hate reclaimed/dismiss path after checking

Chapter 8 — Doxxing / privacy (includes adult NCII)

Definition

Sharing private personal data without consent to harm someone. **NCII** = intimate images or private sexual messages shared without consent.

How to click

Step 2 → **8 Doxxing / privacy**.

Examples

Example	What you choose
Posting someone's home address and phone to "teach them a lesson"	Hard PII → remove (severe); if "we're coming at 8" → **escalate**
Sharing an ex's nudes without permission (adults)	Adult NCII → remove (severe)
Same, but the person is under 18	→ **CSAM escalate**
Posting a coworker's desk location + shift to get them harassed	Workplace doxx → remove (severe)
Linking a public news article or official company page	Public record → dismiss

Chapter 9 — Scam / fraud

Definition

Tricks to steal money or accounts: fake giveaways, fake “Matterya Support,” romance scams, malware links, selling weapons/drugs.

How to click

Step 2 → **9 Scam / fraud** (malware also lives under Spam).

Examples

Example	What you choose
“Send crypto, I’ll double it”	Financial scam → remove (severe)
Fake “Matterya Support” asking for your password	Impersonation → remove (severe)
Romance chat steering someone to wire money	Romance scam → remove (severe)
“Buy this rifle / pills, DM me”	Regulated goods → remove (severe)
Fishy promo but unclear	Suspicious unclear → mark
From our queue: sports celebration clip wrongly tagged scam	Check content — if no ask for money, likely dismiss / wrong category

Chapter 10 — Misinformation

Definition

False claims that can cause real harm (dangerous medical advice, crisis panic) or confuse civic processes. Satire that is clearly a joke is OK. Low-harm rumors can be marked.

How to click

Step 2 → **I Misinformation**.

Examples

Example	What you choose
“Drink bleach to cure infection”	Health harm → remove
Fake “polling place moved” on election day	Civic → mark
Deepfake video of a mayor “confessing,” presented as real	Manipulated → remove
Onion-style clearly labeled parody	Satire → dismiss
“I heard the mall might close?” with no panic claim	Low harm → mark
Fake “tsunami hits city tonight, evacuate now” during calm weather	Crisis panic → remove

Chapter 11 — Adult solicitation

Definition

Adults offering or seeking paid sex, escort services, or pushing unwanted sexual advances. **Not** for minors (that is CSAM). **Not** the same as posting consensual adult porn in a labeled Space (that is Mature).

How to click

Step 2 → **A Adult solicitation**.

Examples

Example	What you choose
“Escort available tonight, rates in bio”	Offering services → remove
“Looking for paid meetup, women only”	Seeking services → remove
Random sexual pickup lines to a stranger who didn’t ask	Unsolicited advances → remove
“Pay $500 or I post your video” (adults)	Concrete sextortion → **escalate**
Any of the above with a minor	→ CSAM escalate

Chapter 12 — Mature / sexual content (adults only)

Definition

Adult porn, nudity, fetish, or suggestive content **with no minors**. Matterya allows labeled adult Spaces (Masquerade) — those are often **marked**, not removed. Unlabeled explicit content in the general feed is usually **removed**.

How to click

Step 2 → **M Mature / sexual content**. If a minor is involved, the first question sends you to CSAM. If it is paid sex / solicitation, it sends you to Adult solicitation.

Examples (many match real queue captions)

Example	What you choose
Explicit adult caption in a clearly adult Masquerade Space (“Getting all the cum out”, “from slow & passionate…”)	Labeled adult space porn → **mark**
Same explicit media dropped unlabeled into a general / all-ages feed	Unlabeled pornography → remove
Artistic nude statue photo for an art Space	Artistic nudity → dismiss
Unwanted flash of genitals in a non-adult Space	Shock nudity → remove
Auto NSFW flag on a cake photo (“Cakes for breakfast”)	False positive → dismiss
Horse nature clip / fireworks B-roll wrongly auto-flagged	False positive → dismiss

Chapter 13 — Spam

Definition

Unwanted ads, floods of the same post, engagement bait, or phishing / malware links.

How to click

Step 2 → **S Spam**.

Examples

Example	What you choose
Same “buy followers” comment pasted 40 times	Flooding → remove
“Click to claim free iPhone” phishing link	Malware / phishing → remove (**severe**)
Mild self-promo that fits the Space	Borderline promo → mark
Challenge hashtag clip with no scam ask (“big bank challenge #matteryachallenge”)	Often OK / dismiss unless it’s bait or malware

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Chapter 14 — Escalate (special safety only)

Definition

Escalate is **not** “I’m unsure of the category.” It is for rare, high-stakes safety cases — same idea as big platforms.

When to use it

Situation	Path
CSAM / grooming / minor NCII / suspected CSAM	Escalate → CSAM
Threat with place / time / target / method (terror or other)	Escalate → specific threat
Suicide crisis with a concrete plan	Escalate → suicide crisis
Confirmed labor / domestic trafficking	Escalate → trafficking
Concrete adult sextortion demand	Escalate → sextortion
High-stakes but still unclear	Escalate → specialist second look

For ordinary doubt (spam vs promo, rude vs harassment) → press P.

Chapter 15 — Account review queue

Definition

A second queue for **accounts**, not posts. You land here after a **severe** remove or after **3 mild** strikes.

What you can do

Action	Plain meaning
Clear strikes	Content action was enough; account OK
Warn	Notify the user; clear strikes
Restrict	Record a temporary restriction + notify
Suspend	Deactivate the account (serious / repeat harm)
Pass	Another moderator should decide

Chapter 16 — Quick practice

Try these mentally before your first real ticket:

- Adult explicit caption in Masquerade adult Space → **Mature** → **labeled** → **mark**
- “I’ll bomb the station at noon” → **Terrorism** → **threat** → **place/time** → **escalate**
- Peru news report of a violent assault, labeled news → **Violence** → **news** → **mark**
- Cake photo auto-flagged NSFW → **Mature** → **false positive** → **dismiss** or **No violation**
- Unsure if rude comment is harassment → P **Pass**

Appendix — Where rules come from

Claim-next follows **Meta Community Standards** and **TikTok Community Guidelines**. YouTube-style longform exceptions are for a **separate longform video queue** (not built for Claim-next).

Live leaf list (technical) is generated at the bottom of the web handbook page for ops.